Computer assisted focused coding and text classification

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Any questions from the lecture?

From open to focused coding

- **Focused coding** means that you settle on a promising theme and then code within it.
- With **open coding**, the goal is to develop theoretically grounded abstractions of data fragments, such as words, sentences, paragraphs, or incidents.

How to use computational methods for focused coding

1. Focus on one of a few categories. Expand keywords. Sample documents to ensure exposure to the category.
2. Sample strategically in order to further theorize and develop the category.
3. Go into depth with sub-categories.
4. Complex search: search two categories, for topic category and actor category, search in specific time periods and/or settings.

How do we validate a measure?

1. Draw a sample, for this course, a minimum of 50 documents (depending on document size)
2. Either a random sample or a dependent random sample (those your model thinks are positives).
3. Manually code this test set using a codebook and evaluate your classification.

How to - codebook

Closed Codebook

The structure is based on MacQueen's (1998) guideline for codebook development.

1. Code: PSYCHOLOGICAL AND EMOTIONAL IMPACT

Brief definition: The mental and emotional effects experienced by victims of sextortion.

Full definition: This code refers to the range of psychological and emotional reactions that victims of sextortion express they experience through the posts to the sextortion subreddit, including fear, anxiety, embarrassment, trauma, and long-term mental health issues. It covers the immediate and lasting impact on a victim's emotional well-being. These distressers lead to a feeling of same and isolation, and worse suicidal thoughts also shared on the subreddit.

When to use: Use this code when a post describes the victim's feelings, emotional reactions, or psychological state as a result of being sextorted.

When not to use: Do not use this for a post discussing technical aspects, procedural details, or advice on handling sextortion and third-party descriptions where the focus is not on the self-reported experiences of the victims.

Example: Immersion Journal # 21, post

"Ever since that happened I'm not the same I have trauma from that experience I deleted Discord for good privated all my social media's. I lived in fear and paranoia took over my life i was shaking didn't take care of my hygiene it destroyed me inside it ate me alive. "

Search words: 'suicide', 'trauma', 'fear', 'anxiety', 'embarrassment', 'emotional', 'impact', 'psychological', 'effect', 'mental', 'health', 'stress', 'paranoia', 'depression', 'sadness', 'hopeless', 'frustration', 'family', 'dark', 'afraid', 'help', 'friend', 'family', 'please', 'ruin', 'scared'

Example

Use a codebook to classify text.

Codebook – How can it look?

- How a structured codebook provides a stable frame for the dynamic analysis of textual data
- How specific codebook features can improve intercoder agreement among multiple researchers;
- The value of team

Codebook structure:

- The code
- A brief description
- A full definition
- Guidelines for when to use the code
- Guidelines for when not to use the code
- Examples

Milestone 3

- Friday, 16th of May, 23:59, via email (xbk406@sodas.ku.dk)
- Feedback next seminar
- Submission should contain (2 pages):
  1. Data collection update
  2. Data analysis design update
  3. Initial analysis (mainly qualitative)

Agenda

1. Project updates

- One slide updates

2. Focused coding

- Sit in your project groups and perform focused coding, for an hour – focus on narrowing down your **analytically relevant themes** and **build your codebooks.**

3. Choose your quantitative analysis

- Dictionary-based classifier/ LLM-based classifier/ supervised ML

Tak for i dag!

Next time: Supervision

Seminar on Thursday: Computer assisted focused coding and text classification

- No readings.